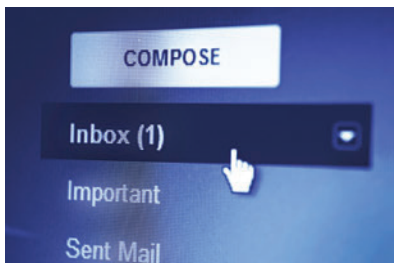


connections also offer better latency and lesser interference compared to wireless networks. Bottomline, if you can, you must consider a wired internet connection / network for your home, as it's just better overall than a pure play wireless network.

08 Email is NOT dead (yet)

Yes, newer forms of communication have become popular over the years – everything from Facebook to Twitter, WhatsApp to Slack – but the good old email is still going strong. You'd be surprised to know that there are 3.9 billion active email users worldwide, projected to reach 4.2 billion in 2024. That's over half the global population!

Regardless of unsolicited marketing emails and spam, why are people still holding onto their email inboxes? I



think it's because email is still one of the few internet technologies that are still open. An email transcends geographical boundaries, connecting people across continents and cultures – where you don't need a corporate cloud inbox but have mail sent from and come to your own computer, accessible offline whenever you want. While newer communication tools offer real-time interaction and social features, the humble email still remains a versatile, ubiquitous, and secure communication channel unlike any other in the digital era.

09 Open source isn't always the best model

Staying on top of constantly evolving open source projects requires a

considerable investment of time, effort and even money, which can be challenging all the time. Yes, community contributions can strengthen the code base, no doubt, but they can also introduce bugs or vulnerabilities if not properly reviewed



in an open source environment. These projects may lack dedicated support teams and comprehensive documentation, making it difficult for some users to troubleshoot issues. Open source software might not always seamlessly integrate with existing proprietary systems or tools, causing critical compatibility issues that can pile up very fast and drain your development-related energy.

For some projects, proprietary software with dedicated support and development might be a better choice. Not everyone can be or afford to have an expert coder or technical team, even few may have the time or inclination to spend time on technical concerns. At these times, proprietary tools and ecosystems help.

10 OTT streaming services are overwhelming

Believe it or not there are close to 50 registered OTT streaming services operating in India, and over 200 all over the world. Forget about the



world, just take a look at OTT services available in India for instance – not only is all the content you want to watch fragmented across different streaming platforms, their restrictive pricing and content release schedule makes it nigh on impossible to keep track of what you want to watch. And even after subscribing to the handful of OTT streaming services, just deciding what to watch can be a herculean task!

Information overload is one thing, the cost of subscribing to different streaming services can very quickly add up and become unsustainable in the long run. And when you find similar content across different platforms, it feels like you're paying twice for the same thing, feeling like you're taken for a ride. Another rising problem after subscribing to all these services: Paying for services but not consuming enough content due to time constraints or lack of interest adds to the overall feeling of not getting what you're paying for with respect to online streaming platforms.

11 Everything doesn't need to be 'smart'



The trend of Internet-of-Things would like to make everything smart and connected. But deep down ask yourself, do you really need all of your devices to become 'smart'? A smart toaster or smart refrigerator that can be controlled from your phone is cool, but does it really offer any significant advantage over a normal one? It's important to know that many 'smart' devices – especially home appliances – boast features rarely or never used,